



MyGurukul

SACRED WISDOM — SATURDAY, FEBRUARY 14, 2026



SACRED TEXT

*śuddhaṃ buddhaṃ priyaṃ pūrṇaṃ niṣprapañcaṃ nirāmayam |
ātmānaṃ taṃ na jānanti tatrābhyāsaparā janāḥ || 18|35| |
nāpnoti karmaṇā mokṣaṃ vimūḍho+abhyāsarūpiṇā |
dhanyo vijñānamātreṇa muktastiṣṭhatyavikriyaḥ || 18|36| |*

— Aṣṭāvakraḡītā, Prakaraṇa 18 (Chapter 18), Verses 35-36

GURU'S INTERPRETATION

Pure, awakened, beloved, complete, free from illusion, and without ailment: this is the Atman, your true Self. Yet, so many strive through arduous practices without ever realizing this inherent perfection. Ashtavakra is highlighting a profound truth about the spiritual path. We often get caught up in the 'doing' – the rituals, the meditations, the self-improvement projects – believing that liberation is something to be earned or achieved through effort. These verses gently remind us that what we seek is already within us, untainted and whole.

The second verse drives this point home: The deluded one does not attain liberation through action in the form of practice. The fortunate one, through mere understanding, remains liberated and unchanging. This isn't an argument against spiritual practice; rather, it's a crucial correction of our understanding. Practice is valuable, but it's not the destination. It's a tool to help you quiet the mind and turn your attention inward, to recognize the truth that is already there. The trap is believing that the practice itself will deliver you.

In today's world, this wisdom is particularly relevant. We are bombarded with messages telling us we are not enough, that we need to constantly strive, improve, and achieve. This creates a sense of lack and fuels endless cycles of striving. Ashtavakra cuts through this illusion, inviting you to recognize the completeness within yourself, independent of external validation or achievement. You are already whole, already perfect. Your task is not to become something you are not, but to simply recognize what you already are. This realization, this 'mere understanding,' is the key to liberation. It's about shifting your focus from doing to being, from striving to recognizing. When you truly understand this, you remain untouched by the ups and downs of life, resting in the unshakeable peace of your true Self.

REFLECTION FOR TODAY

Can you identify one area in your life where you are striving for something you already possess, and how would acknowledging that truth change your approach?